

# L-54 INDIAN VILLAGE — Comprehensive Notes

Anthropology Optional Paper 2 | Unit 5.1 | Sarrthi IAS Foundation | Nataraj Sir

**Syllabus:** Village study significance | Settlement patterns | Little Republics vs Rural Cosmopolitanism | Agrarian relations | Globalization impact | Village as Social System | Traditional Culture

## INDIAN VILLAGE — TOPIC MAP

Village Study Significance → Settlement Types → Little Republics vs Rural Cosmopolitanism  
↓ ↓ ↓  
Agrarian Relations → Globalization Impact → Village as Social System → Traditional Culture

*Core Scholars:* Srinivas | Redfield | Oscar Lewis | Metcalfe | Parsons | Foster | Thorner | Kroeber  
*Core Interlinkages:* Jajmani ↔ Caste ↔ Agrarian ↔ Settlement ↔ Globalization ↔ Social System

## 1. VILLAGE STUDY — SIGNIFICANCE

### What is Village Study?

- In-depth investigation of **social, cultural, economic, political dynamics** of rural communities
- Methods: **Fieldwork + Participant Observation**
- Provides **holistic perspective** on tradition-modernity intersections
- Village = unit of investigation providing **ethnographic insights**

### 1. Diversity of Indian Villages

Indian villages exhibit significant **internal and external diversity**, characterized by **complex social relationships** and **institutional structures**.

### Views on Indian Villages

| Thinker  | View                                                                                                                  |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Gandhi   | "India lives in its villages" — autonomous, self-sufficient, moral, authentic, sustainable                            |
| Nehru    | Did NOT romanticize — villages = backwardness, poverty, stagnation; future in industrialization & modernization       |
| Ambedkar | "A sink of localism, a den of ignorance, and a place of oppression" — caste discrimination, marginalization of Dalits |

### Key Scholars — Village Studies

| Scholar                      | Contribution                                                |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2. Chicago School (Redfield, | Shaped theoretical & methodological foundations (1950s-60s) |

Singer, Marriot)

|                          |                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3. Robert Redfield       | Introduced <b>analytical concept of village India</b> ; Little & Great Traditions                                        |
| 4. William Wiser (1930s) | <i>Hindu Jajmani System</i> ; <i>Behind the Mud Walls</i> — historical background of village studies                     |
| 5. D.N. Majumdar         | <i>Caste &amp; Communication in an Indian Village</i> — impact of new transport & communication on <b>caste mobility</b> |
| 6. S.C. Dube             | <i>Indian Village</i> — considered a <b>classic</b> ; valuable insights into social dynamics                             |
| 7. Oscar Lewis           | Explored <b>Rural Cosmopolitanism</b> — villages NOT isolated                                                            |

### Significance — Theoretical Level

| Concept                                   | Scholar                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Dominant Caste                            | M.N. Srinivas — explores influential caste within a village                          |
| Sanskritization & Westernization          | M.N. Srinivas — cultural changes via emulation of higher castes & Western influences |
| Little Republics vs Rural Cosmopolitanism | Charles Metcalfe vs Oscar Lewis — diverse village social structures                  |
| Little & Great Traditions                 | Robert Redfield — local village vs broader cultural influences                       |
| Universalization & Parochialization       | McKim Marriot — tension between universal & local values                             |
| Sacred Complex                            | L.P. Vidyarthi — interconnectedness of religious beliefs                             |
| Nature-Man-Spirit Complex                 | L.P. Vidyarthi — relationship between nature, humanity, spirituality                 |

**Key Insight from Source:** Village studies not only provide **nuanced understanding** of social dynamics at village level but also contribute to **theoretical frameworks** that shape the broader field of anthropology in India.

## Significance — Applied Level (Policy & Planning)

### Case 1: Community Development Programs (1950s)

India launched community development blocks for rural progress. Village studies showed: if ₹1 crore given for development → went first to **dominant caste hamlets**. Roads, wells, electricity in upper caste areas; Dalit hamlets neglected. Highlighted how **inequality can grow despite development schemes**.

### Case 2: Tribal Sub-Plan (1974)

Aimed to funnel funds to tribal communities. Anthropologists showed **non-tribal intermediaries** (contractors, moneylenders) often captured benefits. Examples: Madhya Pradesh & Odisha — contractors took over schemes meant for tribal welfare.

### Case 3: Barriers to Social Change

George Foster's "Traditional Culture": societies glorify

past, resist change.

- Public toilets under govt schemes failed — **caste prejudices** made people refuse to share bathrooms
- Co-education resisted due to **traditional gender norms**

**Bridge:** Village studies bridged **theory and practice** — enriched anthropology with concepts like dominant caste and Sanskritization, while also **guiding planners in rural development**. They remain vital in understanding the pulse of rural India, where tradition and modernity continue to intersect.

## Anthropological Significance & Contemporary Relevance:

- Village studies pioneered **participant observation methodology** in Indian anthropology — the "village as laboratory" approach remains foundational
- The **dominant caste capture** finding shaped policies like targeted Dalit-sub-plans and SC/ST component schemes
- Today: SVAMITVA scheme (2020) uses drone mapping of village abadis — a modern extension of settlement studies. SECC 2011 data used to identify rural deprivation mirrors what anthropologists documented through fieldwork
- **Applied anthropology** continues — NITI Aayog's Aspirational Districts Programme uses village-level micro-data, echoing the tradition of village studies informing policy
- The debate (Gandhi vs Nehru vs Ambedkar) is still alive in policy: Smart Village vs Smart City debates in Parliament

## 2. SETTLEMENT PATTERNS — TYPES & CHANGES

### Factors Behind Settlement Types

| Factor               | Details                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Physical Features | <b>Altitude, climate, water availability</b> directly influence where people live. Himalayas → clustered in valleys to use fertile land & avoid harsh weather; Rajasthan (arid) → scattered around oases & wells |
| 2. Cultural/Ethnic   | <b>Caste, religion, social structure</b> shape patterns. Some communities live close based on cultural ties. South India → around temples, creating identity & community                                         |
| 3. Security          | Areas prone to <b>raids, thefts, invasions</b> → clustered, fortified villages. Seen in forts across different regions                                                                                           |
| 4. Economic          | Proximity to agricultural land, trade routes, coasts. Fertile plains → agrarian; coastal → fishing; market routes → trade settlements                                                                            |

**Source Conclusion:** Rural settlement patterns reflect an interplay of **geography, culture, security, and economy**. Together, these factors have shaped the unique rural landscape of India over centuries.

### 4 Types of Rural Settlements

| Type                                    | Features                                                                                                                                                                                        | Regions                                                                                                             |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Clustered / Agglomerated / Nucleated | <b>Compact or closely built</b> area of houses; living area distinct from surrounding farms, barns, pastures. Sometimes for <b>security/defense</b>                                             | Fertile alluvial plains, NE states, Bundelkhand, Nagaland, Rajasthan (water scarcity → compact for max utilization) |
| 2. Semi-Clustered / Fragmented          | May result from <b>segregation or fragmentation</b> of large compact village. <b>Land-owning dominant community</b> → <b>central part</b> ; lower strata & menial workers → <b>outer flanks</b> | Gujarat plain, parts of Rajasthan                                                                                   |
| 3. Hamleted                             | Fragmented into <b>several units physically separated</b> but bearing <b>common</b>                                                                                                             | Middle/lower Ganga plain, Chhattisgarh, lower                                                                       |

|                         |                                                                                                                                                                     |                                    |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
|                         | <b>name.</b> Units called <i>panna, para, palli, nagla, dhani</i> . Motivated by <b>social &amp; ethnic factors</b>                                                 | Himalayan valleys                  |
| 4. Dispersed / Isolated | Isolated huts or hamlets in <b>remote jungles or small hills</b> with farms/pasture on slopes. Caused by <b>extremely fragmented terrain</b> and land resource base | Meghalaya, Uttarakhand, HP, Kerala |

### Changes in Settlement Patterns — Anthropological Analysis

| Factor                                           | How it Changed Settlement Patterns                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Caste Dynamics</b>                            | Traditional caste-specific areas breaking down. Changes in social attitudes + govt policies reducing caste-based discrimination → more mixed patterns. Social awareness movements challenged <b>traditional spatial hierarchies</b> |
| <b>Class &amp; Economic Changes</b>              | Changes in agricultural practices, land reforms, economic diversification → new opportunities in certain regions → settlement shifts based on class & economic considerations                                                       |
| <b>Jajmani System &amp; Occupational Changes</b> | Decline of traditional caste-based occupations, rise of new industries → erosion of jajmani system. Modernization & globalization → people seek alternative economic opportunities                                                  |
| <b>Social Mobility</b>                           | Education & access to resources → migration to urban/peri-urban areas. Individuals moving outside <b>caste-specific areas</b> → more diverse, mixed settlement landscape                                                            |
| <b>Modernization &amp; Infrastructure</b>        | Better transport, communication, amenities → movement from isolated areas. Growth of <b>market towns &amp; urban centers</b> attracting populations                                                                                 |
| <b>Govt Policies &amp; Land Reforms</b>          | Redistribution of land, infrastructure projects, incentivizing economic activities → shifts in population distribution. Land reforms reducing landlessness → altered spatial arrangement                                            |

**Source Conclusion:** The anthropological analysis involves considering the interplay of **caste dynamics, class structures, the jajmani system, social mobility,**

**and the impact of modernization.** These factors collectively contribute to the dynamic and evolving nature of rural settlements.

#### **Anthropological Significance & Contemporary Relevance:**

- Settlement patterns are a **spatial reflection of social hierarchy** — semi-clustered settlements literally map caste onto geography (dominant caste = center, marginalized = periphery)
- Today: **SVAMITVA Scheme** (property cards via drone surveys) is documenting these settlement patterns digitally

for the first time — confirming anthropological observations about caste-based spatial segregation

- **Peri-urbanization** is creating new hybrid settlement types not captured in the traditional 4 types — villages near cities like Gurugram, Bengaluru are semi-urban but retain caste-based residential patterns

- **Climate-induced migration** reshaping settlements in coastal Kerala, flood-prone Bihar — new anthropological dimension

- The concept of *dhani* (hamleted) settlements is central to understanding Rajasthan's rural sociology and has implications for service delivery under schemes like PMAY-G

### 3. LITTLE REPUBLIC vs RURAL COSMOPOLITANISM

#### Earlier Perception — "Little Republics"

 **Handwritten fill:** Scholars like **Henry Maine**, **Charles Metcalfe**, **Baden Powell** described Indian villages as **self-sufficient and autonomous**.

 **Metcalfe** famously said Indian villages were like **"tiny republics, standing firm even when kingdoms rose and fell"** around them.

 **Maine and Powell** also admired this local autonomy — villages as miniature states capable of independent functioning.

#### Metcalfe's Idea — Key Features

| Feature                                       | Details                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Self-Sufficiency &amp; Autonomy</b>     | Self-reliant units with own social, economic, political structures. Managed agriculture, cottage industries, local needs without heavy dependence on external authorities |
| <b>2. Social &amp; Political Independence</b> | Local governance via <b>Panchayat</b> — resolved disputes, managed affairs. Self-governance reduced dependence on central authority                                       |
| <b>3. Role in Social Cohesion</b>             | Prevented concentration of power in central authorities. Fostered <b>community solidarity</b> and balanced societal structure                                             |

#### Supporting Examples

- **Panchayat System:** Village councils as local self-government — judicial + administrative matters
- **Traditional Economy:** Agriculture + cottage industries → village relatively independent; goods/services exchanged within community

#### Limitations

- Villages were **NOT completely isolated**
- Engaged in **trade, communication, and cultural exchange** with nearby villages/towns
- While there was autonomy, there was also **interconnectedness**

#### Significance

- Important for both **anthropology and political science**
- Highlights how **local autonomy and self-governance** can ensure social harmony and prevent excessive centralization

- **Critiques by Nehru & Ambedkar:** villages were also sites of **inequality, poverty, and caste oppression**

#### ARE VILLAGES AUTONOMOUS? — Analysis

##### Arguments FOR (Little Republic):

- Each village has its own **power structure** and a few powerful individuals having control
- The **agrarian structure, the Jajmani system** — people's needs met through exchange of goods/services
- **No intervention** of other villages in the working of one village

##### Arguments AGAINST (Rural Cosmopolitanism):

- Socio-cultural institutions like **marriage** — families have ties with other villages
- **Kinship** is spread across many villages
- Villages depend on other villages for **religious activities** (pilgrimages, festivals)
- These act as **bridges forming inter-village ties**

#### Rural Cosmopolitanism — Oscar Lewis

**Oscar Lewis** — studied **Rani Khera village (near New Delhi)**

Came up with concept of **RURAL COSMOPOLITANISM**  
Went **against** the "Little Republic" concept of **Charles Metcalfe**

**Key argument:** Villages are NOT self-sufficient and independent — they always maintain ties with other villages for **social, cultural, economic, religious, and political** activities.

Submitted paper at **seminar on Indian villages at University of Chicago**.

#### Mexico vs India — Lewis's Comparison (Chicago Seminar)

| Mexico                                     | India                                          |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Villages are <b>"inward looking"</b>       | Villages form a <b>complex network</b>         |
| No socio-cultural ties with other villages | <b>Socio-cultural ties</b> — marriage, exogamy |
| Follow <b>village endogamy</b>             | <b>Economic ties</b> — trade                   |
| Inter-village network only for trade       | <b>Religious ties</b> — pilgrimage             |
|                                            | <b>Political ties</b>                          |

|  |                                                   |
|--|---------------------------------------------------|
|  | Lewis calls this " <b>RURAL COSMOPOLITANISM</b> " |
|--|---------------------------------------------------|

## Indian Examples of Rural Cosmopolitanism

- 1. Jallikattu (Tamil Nadu):** Traditional bull-taming during Pongal festival — participants from **multiple villages** come together, fostering inter-village social bonds and showcasing interconnectedness of rural communities.
- 2. Rath Yatras (Chariot Processions):** Jagannath Rath Yatra in Puri, Odisha — pilgrims from **various villages** participate, creating shared **religious and cultural identity** across communities.
- 3. Village Fairs & Melas:** Annual fairs attract participants from neighboring villages — platforms for **cultural exchange, economic activities (trade/commerce), and social interactions**.

**Source Conclusion:** Indian villages are NOT isolated "little republics" but **dynamic, interconnected communities** shaped by social, economic, and cultural change. Anthropological studies show villagers are **active agents**, adapting and reshaping their societies —

necessary to view villages as **complex and evolving social formations**.

## Anthropological Significance & Contemporary Relevance:

- This debate is foundational to **village ethnography methodology** — should the anthropologist study one village in isolation (Metcalf) or study inter-village networks (Lewis)?
- **Contemporary validation of Lewis:** WhatsApp groups connecting families across villages; matrimonial networks spanning districts; SHG federations linking multiple GPs — all examples of rural cosmopolitanism intensified by technology
- **Panchayat elections** today involve inter-village political alliances, caste coalitions across gram sabhas — village politics is NOT inward-looking
- The **2017 Jallikattu protests** in Tamil Nadu (SC ban → massive protests → ordinance) showed how a "rural" practice mobilized inter-village and urban-rural solidarity — a 21st-century example of rural cosmopolitanism
- **For UPSC:** This is a high-value debate — can be used in both Paper 1 (theoretical) and Paper 2 (Indian village) answers. Always present BOTH sides + Lewis's evidence + contemporary examples

## 4. AGRARIAN RELATIONS IN INDIAN VILLAGES

### Definition

- **Agrarian social structure** = organization of rural life around **agriculture**
- Marked by: **caste hierarchies, land ownership & tenancy patterns, gender inequalities**
- Land concentrated in hands of a few; most farmers are tenants or laborers
- This structure shapes **social relations, power, and livelihoods** of rural communities

### Two Components of Agrarian Structure

The agrarian social structure is contingent upon two key components:

- **Technological arrangements** — machinery & technology for agricultural purposes
- **Social arrangements** — power structure, land ownership, and control

**Relationship:** As technological advancements ↑ → reliance on social arrangements ↓ (and vice versa). In some Asian societies, economic and social institutions are **interconnected**.

### Peasant Society — A.L. Kroeber

**A.L. Kroeber:** Peasant society = "**part society**" — signifying reliance on a **larger society** across technological, economic, political, administrative, religious, and moral spheres.  
Social structures are intricately woven into the fabric of **caste and class relationships**.

### Daniel Thorner's Classification (3 Parts)

| Category                          | Local Term   | Description                                                                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Proprietors / Landowners</b>   | <b>Malik</b> | Mostly <b>rich upper-caste</b> groups owning large tracts. Held <b>dominant power</b> . E.g.: Zamindars, Jagirdars pre-independence      |
| <b>Working Peasants / Tenants</b> | <b>Kisan</b> | Largely <b>middle castes</b> . Small landowners or tenants leasing from Maliks. " <b>Backbone of cultivation</b> " in Indian agriculture |

|                              |                |                                                                                                                                       |
|------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Agricultural Laborers</b> | <b>Mazdoor</b> | Mostly <b>landless workers from lower castes</b> . Dependent on wages, sharecropping, casual labor. Lowest rung of agrarian structure |
|------------------------------|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

This social structure has seen **significant decline post-independence** due to **social mobility and depeasantization** → rise of new powerful classes and castes.

### D.N. Dhanangre (1983) — Extended Classification

**D.N. Dhanangre (1983):** Critiqued Thorner's categories as insufficient. Need to regroup into broader, more comprehensive model using concepts from **Lenin and Mao** (analysis of agrarian classes in Russian & Chinese societies):

1. **Landlords** — large landowners, often not cultivating themselves
2. **Rich peasants** — enough land to hire laborers
3. **Middle peasants** — small plots, family labor
4. **Poor peasants** — very small plots, dependent on others
5. **Landless laborers** — no land, daily wages

*Key observation:* Social composition (castes, religious/ethnic groups) is "**far too complex in different regions of India to reduce into any simplistic formulae**" — however, a loose, broad classification may hold ground.

### Social Stratification — Caste-Class Links

| Agrarian Class                                                                    | Caste Groups                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Landlords &amp; rich landowners</b> (incl. non-cultivating urban moneylenders) | Upper castes: <b>Brahmin, Thakur, Bania</b> (N. India); <b>Kamma, Reddi, Rao</b> (AP); <b>Okkaliga, Lingayat</b> (Mysore/Karnataka); <b>Patidar</b> (Gujarat); <b>Kunbi Maratha, Deshmukh</b> (Maharashtra) |
| <b>Middle &amp; poor peasantry</b> (debt-burdened)                                | Traditional castes of <b>cultivators, artisans</b> , and the like                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Landless laborers</b>                                                          | Predominantly <b>untouchable castes / Scheduled Castes</b>                                                                                                                                                  |

### Changes in Agrarian Structure

| Change              | Details                                                                                                      |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Land Reforms        | Redistributed ownership; increased small/marginal farmers; reduced concentration & large landowner influence |
| Tenancy Patterns    | Laws amended → better tenant protection, improved credit access; reduced landlord-tenant power imbalance     |
| Caste Hierarchies   | Social mobility via education; caste's influence in determining status declining (though still present)      |
| Gender Inequalities | Women's participation in agriculture improved via govt policies promoting gender equality                    |

Changes slow and incremental — but step in right direction. Still long way to go.

Reasons for Changes

- **Government policies:** Land reforms, tenancy improvement, gender equality programs
- **Economic factors:** Growth of non-agricultural industries, service sector → decline of agriculture as sole livelihood

- **Social factors:** Education, increased mobility → changes in caste hierarchies
- **Technological advances:** Improved irrigation, farm machinery → changed practices, increased productivity, changed land ownership patterns

**Anthropological Significance & Contemporary Relevance:**

- Kroeber's "part society" concept explains why **farmer suicides** cluster when the larger society's market/credit systems fail — peasants cannot self-sustain
- Thorner's Malik-Kisan-Mazdoor model is still used in **NSSO Agricultural Census analysis** to classify rural households
- **Contract farming laws (2020, later repealed)** are a direct extension of the shift from Jajmani to contract employment documented by Chand & Srivastava
- **FPOs (Farmer Producer Organizations)** represent a new institutional form — Kisans organizing collectively to bypass Maliks/middlemen
- **Feminization of agriculture:** As male members migrate, women increasingly manage farms — yet land titles remain male-dominated (only ~13% women landowners per Agri Census 2015-16)
- **Caste-class overlap persists:** SC/ST households constitute ~60% of agricultural labor (PLFS 2023-24)

## 5. IMPACT OF GLOBALIZATION ON INDIAN VILLAGES

### Definition

Globalization = process by which world is becoming increasingly interconnected due to **massively increased trade and cultural exchange**. Accelerated since 18th century (transportation + communication tech).

**Anthony Giddens:** "The **gradual integration of economies and societies** across the world."  
= **Interconnectedness and interdependence** of nations, cultures, communities at global scale.

### Indian Villages — Pre-Globalization

- Centers of **self-sufficiency**, embodiment of **collectivism**
- Followed **pre-literate and early methods** of economic practices
- These practices contributed to **well-founded social relations** between different caste people
- Jajmani system** = one such example of inter-caste economic arrangement

### 8 Impacts of Globalization on Indian Villages

| # | Impact                               | Scholar/Study                                                                                                       | Key Points                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|---|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Major Trends in Village Economy      |  <b>A.R. Desai's Perspective</b> | 4 trends: (a) subsistence → surplus economy, (b) modern technology, (c) abolition of intermediaries (Zamindars), (d) emergence of associations/institutions linked with urban & national organizations |
| 2 | Transformation of Agrarian Relations | <b>Chand &amp; Srivastava (2014)</b> — Jamgod Village, MP                                                           | Traditional relations favoring local dominant caste <b>disrupted</b> . Shift to <b>contract-based employment</b> over traditional payment in kind                                                      |
| 3 | Depeasantization & Status Change     | <b>Tilche</b> — Patidars of Sundarana, Gujarat                                                                      | Globalization enabled Patidars (traditional agri community) to free from agriculture via <b>education, employment, emigration</b> . Reshaping <b>status calculations</b> —                             |

|   |                                     |                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                               |
|---|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   |                                     |                                                                                                          | farming no longer status marker                                                                                                                                               |
| 4 | New Conflicts & Practice Changes    | <b>Simpson (2016)</b> — various village studies                                                          | <b>Market economy + education</b> → conflict between agri & non-agri ways of life. <b>Jajmani decline</b> ; reduced appeal for <b>Sanskritization</b>                         |
| 5 | Joint Family Disruption             |  <b>Iravati Karve</b> | Globalization contributed to <b>disruption of joint families</b> (weakening ties)                                                                                             |
| 6 | Jajmani System Decline              | <b>William Wiser</b> (defined system)                                                                    | Each caste providing standardized service to others — <b>greatly by globalization</b> , rarely observed today. Causes: role of state tech innovations, political mobilization |
| 7 | Social Customs & Traditions Erosion | —                                                                                                        | <b>Westernization of culture</b> through global media → eroded traditional values, questioning age-old practices                                                              |
| 8 | Impact on Agriculture               | —                                                                                                        | Facilitated mobility/connectivity <b>rapid migration</b> . Mechanization, improved seeds, fertilizers, pesticides primarily <b>benefiting big, rich farmers</b>               |

**Source Conclusion:** Impact is **multifaceted** — transformations in agrarian relations, depeasantization, changes in status calculations, emergence of new conflicts, disruption of traditional practices, and decline of Jajmani system. Shift towards **surplus economy, modern technology**, and changes in social customs reflect how global forces have **reshaped and challenged** the traditional fabric of village life.

### Anthropological Significance & Contemporary Relevance:

- Depeasantization is accelerating:** Agriculture's share in GDP fell to ~15% (2024-25) but still employs ~42% of workforce — this mismatch is the core agrarian crisis
- Patidar agitation (2015-16, Gujarat)** for OBC reservation illustrates Tilche's depeasantization finding — a traditionally agricultural community seeking non-farm opportunities
- Digital globalization's new impact:** e-NAM (electronic National Agricultural Market) disrupts traditional mandi

system; Amazon/Flipkart logistics hubs in rural areas create non-farm employment

- **GI tags** (Darjeeling tea, Banarasi silk) represent villages engaging with global markets while preserving traditional identities — a nuanced globalization impact
- The **2020-21 farm law protests** were fundamentally about

globalization's impact on agrarian relations — contract farming, corporate entry, MSP removal fears

- **Remittance economy:** Gulf/urban migration remittances reshape rural power structures — a Mazdoor's son earning abroad may command more status than a Malik's farming heir

## 6. INDIAN VILLAGE AS A SOCIAL SYSTEM

### Definitions

- **System:** Orderly arrangement; inter-relationship of parts where every part has a **fixed place and definite role**. Parts do NOT exist in isolation — bound by **constant interaction**
- **Social System:** "The **patterned** series of **interrelationships** existing between individuals, groups, and institutions forming a **coherent whole**"

 **Talcott Parsons:** "Social system consists of a **plurality of social actors** engaged in more or less stable **interaction** according to **shared cultural norms and meaning**."

- Interaction = '**patterned interaction**'
- Takes under its orbit all diverse **sub-systems** — economic, political, religious, and others

### 5 Key Features of Social System (Parsons) — Applied to Indian Village

| Feature                                  | Meaning                                                        | Indian Village Example                                                                                                           |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Plurality of Individual Actors</b> | Multiple interacting individuals within system                 | Diverse population — different castes, occupations, age groups                                                                   |
| <b>2. Aims &amp; Objectives</b>          | Every social system must have specific aims; avoid aimlessness | Maintaining social harmony, preserving cultural traditions, ensuring well-being of members                                       |
| <b>3. Order &amp; Pattern</b>            | Organized structure with order among functional units          | Economic, political, religious subsystems coexist and interact in structured way                                                 |
| <b>4. Functional Unity</b>               | Unity between constituents via functional relationships        | Economic activities, religious practices, social interactions contribute to overall stability                                    |
| <b>5. Maintenance</b>                    | Via socialization + social control; vital for longevity        | Socialization = cultural norm transmission to younger generations; Social control = enforcement of rules, preventing disruptions |

### How Indian Village Qualifies as Social System

**Constant interaction** between individuals; **no anonymity** because of small population and high density.

### 3 Subsystems of Indian Village

**INDIAN VILLAGE = SOCIAL SYSTEM (PARSONS)**

**Caste-Jajmani** (Economic-Ritual) | **Panchayati Raj** (Political) | **Joint Family** (Socialization)

All three fulfill: Plurality → Aims → Order → Functional  
Unity → Maintenance

#### 1. Caste & Jajmani System (Economic-Ritual Subsystem)

- **Plurality:** Different castes (Brahmins, artisans, service castes) = multiple actors in constant interaction
- **Order & pattern:** Caste hierarchy = fixed order; Jajmani defines who provides what service
- **Functional unity:** Interdependence (barber cuts hair → farmer gives grain) — village runs **like a body with organs**
- Caste-Jajmani = **subsystem ensuring economic and ritual order**

#### 2. Panchayati Raj (Political Subsystem)

- **Aims:** Local governance, justice, development. Avoids aimlessness by setting common goals
- **Order & pattern:** Democratic rules, elections, dispute resolution → stability in social & political life
- **Maintenance:** Social control exercised by panchayats — reducing conflict, enforcing norms
- Panchayat = **political subsystem** aligning with Parsons' idea of maintaining order

#### 3. Joint Family (Socialization Subsystem)

- **Plurality:** Many generations live together, interacting daily
- **Functional unity:** Role division — elders guide, adults earn, children learn. Unity from shared labor & values
- **Maintenance:** Socialization of children, discipline, transmission of culture → continuity

- Joint family = **socialization and control subsystem**, ensuring value transmission

**Source Conclusion:** The Indian village is a **cohesive social system**, and within the larger Indian society, it acts as a **subsystem**. With its constant interaction, deep-rooted social structures (caste, Jajmani), and the role of Panchayati Raj and joint family in socialization and control, it exhibits **all crucial features** of a social system. It can be confidently affirmed that the Indian village serves as a **cohesive and functioning social system** within the broader societal framework.

#### **Anthropological Significance & Contemporary Relevance:**

- Parsons' **structural-functionalist** framework gives anthropologists a tool to analyze ANY community as a

system — widely used in village ethnographies

- **Challenge today:** With Jajmani declining and joint families fragmenting, is the village still a "system"? Or is it becoming a **disaggregated set of individuals** connected more to urban markets than to each other?

- **73rd Constitutional Amendment (1992)** formalized the Panchayat subsystem — but created tension with traditional caste panchayats (khap panchayats) that still operate informally

- **Women sarpanches** (33% reservation, 50% in some states) are disrupting the traditional male-dominated political subsystem — an evolution within the social system framework

- **For UPSC:** This is a straightforward conceptual question — always structure answer as: Define Parsons → 5 features → 3 subsystems → conclusion. Score high with clear diagram/table

## 7. TRADITIONAL CULTURE — George Foster

**George Foster** (American anthropologist)

Developed concept from fieldwork in **Mexico (Latin America)**

Definition: "Cultural practices and beliefs **transmitted from one generation to the next**, creating **continuity and stability** in society."

### Key Features

| Feature                             | Detail                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Stability &amp; Coherence</b> | Traditions preserved carefully, often through <b>oral transmission</b> (songs, rhymes, rituals). People follow path of <b>forefathers</b> , ensuring continuity |
| <b>2. Identity &amp; Continuity</b> | Provides <b>sense of belonging and order</b> . Festivals, fairs, community gatherings reinforce cultural values                                                 |
| <b>3. Adaptiveness &amp; Change</b> | Traditions may <b>adapt slowly</b> to environment and new challenges. But change is <b>resisted</b> if it threatens core cultural values                        |

### How Traditional Culture Creates **BARRIERS** to Social Change

- Cultural patterns may **resist modernization** or new practices
- Traditions can become **cultural barriers** that hinder reforms

### Global Examples

- Gender roles in rural Africa** → limit women's education & employment
- Resistance to Western medicine** among indigenous groups (faith in traditional healing)
- Resource use in tribal South America** (hunting/fishing traditions) conflicting with conservation laws

### Indian Examples — Traditional Culture as Barrier

#### 1. Caste System:

- One of the **oldest cultural practices** in India
- Enforces **rigid social segregation** — interaction, marriage, even residence shaped by caste
- Higher castes controlled resources & rituals; lower castes marginalized

- Limits social mobility** and blocks reforms aimed at equality
- Example: Dalits still face exclusion from village resources (wells, temples)

#### 2. Sanitation Practices 🖋️:

**Dean Spears & Michael Geruso (2018)**: Hindus far less likely than Muslims to use toilets, **even at same income level**

- Traditional belief: open defecation away from home = "**purier**" than keeping waste inside
- High levels of open defecation → **child mortality + poor health outcomes**
- Despite govt investment (**Swachh Bharat Abhiyan**), this cultural barrier persists

#### 3. Caste Segregation — Karnataka 🖋️:

**Naveen Bharathi et al. (2020)**: Intra-village segregation in Karnataka > **black-white segregation in American South**

🖋️ **Spate & Learmonth (1954)**: Ethnographic research — residential space mirrors **caste hierarchy**

**Village Example — Amminabhavi (near Dharwad, Karnataka)**:

- Dalits** (formerly "untouchables," labelled Harijans in early studies) → pushed to **periphery**
- Dominant landholding castes** → occupy **center**
- Other worker castes (Talwars, Shepherds, Washermen) → relegated to **margins**
- Village headman** and kin control best land parcels, living in large "manor house"

Ambedkar: villages = "**sink of localism and a den of narrow-mindedness**"

#### 4. Child Marriage:

- Rooted in cultural values of **family honor and purity** — girls married young
- Restricts education & economic opportunities** for women
- Increases risks: early pregnancies, poor health, domestic violence
- Despite **legal prohibition**, persists in many rural areas — deeply tied to traditional notions of social order

#### 5. Female Infanticide:

- Traditional preference for **male children** → female infanticide, sex-selective abortions

- Cultural beliefs: sons ensure lineage, economic support, last rites; daughters = financial burden (dowry)
- Result: **distorted sex ratio** — itself a barrier to gender equality & social reform

## Criticism of Foster

- Too **simplistic** — assumes cultures are **static**
- Overlooks that traditions are **dynamic, evolving, and negotiable**
- Sometimes used to justify **cultural purity** and **exclude minorities**

**Source Conclusion:** Foster's concept highlights the **dual role** of traditions: On one hand, they preserve **identity, continuity, and stability**. On the other, they can act as **barriers to social change** (caste segregation, sanitation beliefs). For meaningful development, reforms must **engage with cultural values** rather than work against them. Culture = both a **"shield"** that protects communities and a **"wall"** that obstructs progressive change unless addressed with sensitivity.

## Anthropological Significance & Contemporary Relevance:

- Foster's concept is a core tool in **applied/development anthropology** — explains why top-down modernization fails without cultural engagement
- **Swachh Bharat Mission Phase II** now uses **community-led total sanitation (CLTS)** — triggering disgust rather than imposing toilets. This is anthropological insight in action (engaging with, not against, cultural values)
- **Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (2015)**: Directly addresses female infanticide and child marriage — but success varies by state because cultural barriers differ regionally
- **Naveen Bharathi's Karnataka segregation study (2020)** is now cited in SC judgments and parliamentary debates — anthropological research influencing law
- **Interlinkage with other topics:** Traditional culture as barrier connects to: Sanskritization (cultural emulation as change agent), Westernization (external cultural force), and Modernization (institutional/structural change) — all from L-51
- **For UPSC:** Foster's concept is a versatile answer-building tool — can be used for questions on barriers to development, culture vs modernity, caste persistence, gender issues, sanitation policy

## CURRENT HOOKS — Recent Developments (2025-26)

**1. Budget 2025-26 — Rural Development:** Rs 1,88,754 crore allocated for comprehensive development across 6.65 lakh villages, supporting 2.68 lakh Gram Panchayats. Jal Jeevan Mission extended to 2028; 12.2 crore households with tap water (Jan 2025). MGNREGS expanded to **125 days/year** (from 100).

**2. Vibrant Villages Programme-II (April 2025):** Central Sector Scheme for comprehensive development of **1,954 villages** on international borders across 15 states + 2 UTs. Links to settlement pattern changes in border areas.

**3. MPI Poverty Decline:** National Multidimensional Poverty Index shows decline from **24.85%** → **14.96%** (2015-16 to 2019-21); **13.5 crore** individuals escaped poverty.

Demonstrates impact of rural development schemes on village societies.

**4. Caste Segregation Persists (2025):** 113 caste atrocity incidents recorded Jan-Jun 2025 (UP: 34, MP: 15, TN: 8). In Tirunelveli, students wear colored T-shirts indicating caste; in Barmer, an 8-yr-old Dalit boy beaten for touching upper-caste water pot. Validates Bharathi et al.'s segregation findings.

**5. Rural Urbanization Study (Nijman et al., 2026):** Published in *Urban Studies* — traditional power relations of **class and caste** shape emergent urbanizing landscapes. Rural areas (65% of population) still systematically subsidize urban prosperity through resource extraction, cheap food, and migrant labour.

## KEY QUOTES — Use in Mains Answers

**Gandhi:** "India lives in its villages."

**Ambedkar:** "A sink of localism, a den of ignorance, and a place of oppression."

**Ambedkar (on Amminabhavi-type villages):** "Sink of localism and a den of narrow-mindedness."

**Metcalf:** Indian villages = "tiny republics, standing firm even when kingdoms rose and fell."

**Kroeber:** Peasant society = "part society."

**Parsons:** "Social system consists of a plurality of social actors engaged in more or less stable interaction according to shared cultural norms and meaning."

**Giddens:** "The gradual integration of economies and societies across the world."

**Bharathi et al.:** Intra-village segregation in Karnataka > black-white segregation in American South.

**Foster (conceptual):** Culture = both a "shield" and a "wall."

**Dhanangre:** Social composition of agrarian classes "far too complex to reduce into any simplistic formulae."

## HANDWRITTEN ANNOTATIONS INDEX

| Page | Blank Filled With                           | Context                                            |
|------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| p.10 | Henry Maine, Charles Metcalfe, Baden Powell | Scholars who described villages as self-sufficient |
| p.10 | Metcalfe                                    | "Tiny republics" quote attribution                 |
| p.10 | Maine and Powell                            | Admired local autonomy                             |
| p.17 | A.R. Desai's Perspective                    | 4 major trends in village economy                  |
| p.18 | Iravati Karve                               | Disruption of joint families                       |
| p.19 | Talcott Parsons                             | Social system definition                           |
| p.23 | Dean Spears and Michael Geruso (2018)       | Sanitation practices study                         |

|      |                                      |                                           |
|------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| p.23 | <b>Naveen Bharathi et al. (2020)</b> | Karnataka caste segregation               |
| p.24 | <b>Spate &amp; Learmonth, 1954</b>   | Residential space mirrors caste hierarchy |

GOVERNMENT SCHEMES — Summary Table

| Scheme / Policy                 | Year             | Relevance to Village Studies                                                  |
|---------------------------------|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Community Development Programs  | 1950s            | Rural development; village studies showed dominant-caste capture of funds     |
| Tribal Sub-Plan                 | 1974             | Tribal development; non-tribal intermediaries captured benefits               |
| Land Reforms                    | Post-1947        | Changed agrarian social structure; reduced Zamindar power; more small farmers |
| Panchayati Raj (73rd Amendment) | 1992             | Political subsystem of village; local self-governance; women's reservation    |
| Swachh Bharat Abhiyan           | 2014             | Sanitation; cultural beliefs as barrier (Foster's traditional culture)        |
| SVAMITVA Scheme                 | 2020             | Drone mapping of village properties; documenting settlement patterns          |
| Jal Jeevan Mission              | 2019 (ext. 2028) | Tap water to all rural HHs — settlement/development change                    |
| MGNREGS (125 days)              | 2006/2025        | Rural employment guarantee; shifts agrarian labor relations                   |
| Vibrant Villages Programme-II   | 2025             | Border village development — 1,954 villages across 15 states                  |
| Beti Bachao Beti Padhao         | 2015             | Addresses female infanticide/child marriage — cultural barriers               |

COMPLETE SCHOLAR REFERENCE TABLE

| Scholar                                                                                             | Concept / Work                                                 | Topic                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Mahatma Gandhi                                                                                      | "India lives in its villages" — autonomous, moral              | Views on villages                        |
| Jawaharlal Nehru                                                                                    | Villages = backwardness, stagnation                            | Views on villages                        |
| B.R. Ambedkar                                                                                       | "Sink of localism, den of ignorance, place of oppression"      | Views on villages                        |
| Robert Redfield                                                                                     | Analytical concept of village India; Little & Great Traditions | Village studies theory                   |
| Milton Singer                                                                                       | Chicago School — theoretical foundations                       | Village studies theory                   |
| McKim Marriot                                                                                       | Universalization & Parochialization                            | Village studies theory                   |
| M.N. Srinivas                                                                                       | Dominant Caste; Sanskritization; Westernization                | Village studies theory                   |
| L.P. Vidyarthi                                                                                      | Sacred Complex; Nature-Man-Spirit Complex                      | Village studies theory                   |
| William Wiser (1930s)                                                                               | <i>Hindu Jajmani System; Behind the Mud Walls</i>              | Historical village studies; Jajmani      |
| D.N. Majumdar                                                                                       | <i>Caste &amp; Communication in an Indian Village</i>          | Transport/communication & caste mobility |
| S.C. Dube                                                                                           | <i>Indian Village</i> (classic)                                | Village social dynamics                  |
|  Henry Maine      | Supported village as little republic                           | Village autonomy                         |
|  Charles Metcalfe | "Tiny republics" — self-sufficient                             | Little Republics concept                 |
|  Baden Powell     | Supported village as little republic                           | Village autonomy                         |
| Oscar Lewis                                                                                         | Rural Cosmopolitanism (study of Rani Khera, near Delhi)        | Against little republic idea             |
| A.L. Kroeber                                                                                        | Peasant society = "part society"                               | Agrarian relations                       |
| Daniel Thorner                                                                                      | 3-part classification: Malik, Kisan, Mazdoor                   | Agrarian social structure                |
| D.N. Dhanangre (1983)                                                                               | 5-class model from Lenin & Mao; complexity argument            | Agrarian social structure                |

|                                                                                                                                 |                                                                       |                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| <b>Anthony Giddens</b>                                                                                                          | Globalization = gradual integration of economies/societies            | Globalization definition          |
|  <b>A.R. Desai</b>                              | 4 major trends in village economy post-globalization                  | Globalization impact              |
| <b>Chand &amp; Srivastava (2014)</b>                                                                                            | Jamgod Village, MP — shift to contract employment                     | Globalization: agrarian relations |
| <b>Tilche</b>                                                                                                                   | Patidars of Sundarana, Gujarat — depeasantization                     | Globalization: status change      |
| <b>Simpson (2016)</b>                                                                                                           | Conflicts between agri & non-agri life; jajmani decline               | Globalization: new conflicts      |
|  <b>Iravati Karve</b>                           | Disruption of joint families                                          | Globalization: family             |
|  <b>Talcott Parsons</b>                         | Social system — plurality, aims, order, functional unity, maintenance | Village as social system          |
| <b>George Foster</b>                                                                                                            | "Traditional Culture" — fieldwork in Mexico                           | Traditional culture as barrier    |
|  <b>Dean Spears &amp; Michael Geruso (2018)</b> | Hindus less likely to use toilets at same income                      | Sanitation cultural barrier       |
|  <b>Naveen Bharathi et al. (2020)</b>           | Karnataka caste segregation > American South                          | Caste segregation                 |
|  <b>Spate &amp; Learmonth (1954)</b>            | Residential space mirrors caste hierarchy                             | Caste segregation                 |

## QUICK REVISION CHEAT SHEET

| Topic                                              | Main Points (Keywords)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Key Scholars                                                                                 | Examples                                                                                                                                      | Key Case Studies                                                                            |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1. Village Study Significance</b>               | Fieldwork, participant observation; holistic; 7 theoretical concepts (dominant caste, Sanskritization, Little/Great Traditions, U&P, Sacred Complex, NMS); applied: policy capture by dominant castes; bridged theory & practice                                    | Srinivas, Redfield, Singer, Marriot, Vidyarthi, Wiser, Majumdar, Dube, Lewis                 | CDP funds → dominant caste hamlets; Tribal Sub-Plan capture in MP/Odisha; toilet sharing refused (caste); co-ed resisted (gender norms)       | CDP (1950s); Tribal Sub-Plan (1974); Foster's Traditional Culture barriers                  |
| <b>2. Settlement Patterns</b>                      | 4 factors (physical, cultural, security, economic); 4 types (CSHD): Clustered, Semi-clustered, Hamleted, Dispersed; local names: panna/para/palli/nagla/dhani; 6 change factors (caste, class, jajmani, mobility, modernization, govt)                              | —                                                                                            | Himalayas → valleys; Rajasthan → oases; South India → temples; Gujarat (semi-clustered); Ganga plain (hamleted); Meghalaya/Kerala (dispersed) | Bundelkhand clustered; Rajasthan water scarcity; Gujarat dominant caste center              |
| <b>3. Little Republic vs Rural Cosmopolitanism</b> | Metcalf: tiny republics, self-sufficient, panchayat; Limitations: not isolated; Lewis: Rani Khera, complex network; 4 types of ties (social-marriage, economic-trade, religious-pilgrimage, political); Mexico (inward/endogamy) vs India (cosmopolitan)            | Metcalf, Maine, Baden Powell, Oscar Lewis; Critics: Nehru, Ambedkar                          | Jallikattu (TN); Rath Yatra (Puri); Village fairs/melas                                                                                       | Rani Khera village study (Lewis); Chicago seminar paper                                     |
| <b>4. Agrarian Relations</b>                       | Caste-class link; tech vs social arrangements; "part society"; Malik-Kisan-Mazdoor; 5-class (Dhanangre from Lenin/Mao); regional caste-class mapping; 4 changes (land reforms, tenancy, caste decline, gender); 4 reasons (govt, economic, social, tech)            | Kroeber, Thorner, Dhanangre (1983), Lenin, Mao                                               | Zamindars/Jagirdars; Kamma/Reddi (AP); Okkaliga/Lingayat (Karnataka); Patidar (Gujarat); Kunbi Maratha (MH); SC landless laborers             | Regional caste-class too complex for formulae (Dhanangre)                                   |
| <b>5. Globalization Impact</b>                     | 8 impacts: economy trends (4 by Desai), agri relations (contract), depeasantization (status), new conflicts (agri vs non-agri), joint family disruption, jajmani decline, cultural erosion, agri mechanization; pre-glob: self-sufficient, Jajmani                  | Giddens, A.R. Desai, Chand & Srivastava (2014), Tilche, Simpson (2016), Iravati Karve, Wiser | Jamgod MP (contract labor); Sundarana Gujarat (Patidar emigration); mechanization benefits rich                                               | Chand & Srivastava 2014; Tilche Patidars; Simpson 2016                                      |
| <b>6. Village as Social System</b>                 | Parsons: 5 features (PAOFM: plurality, aims, order, functional unity, maintenance); 3 subsystems (CJP): Caste-Jajmani (economic-ritual), Panchayat (political), Joint Family (socialization); patterned interaction; constant interaction, no anonymity             | Talcott Parsons                                                                              | Jajmani exchange (barber ↔ farmer); Panchayat dispute resolution; Joint family role division                                                  | Jajmani diagram (Kamin → Jajman ← Kumhaar/Nai/Lohaar)                                       |
| <b>7. Traditional Culture</b>                      | Foster: Mexico; transmitted beliefs; 3 features (stability, identity, adaptiveness); BARRIER: 5 Indian examples (caste, sanitation, Karnataka segregation, child marriage, female infanticide); 3 global examples; criticism: too static; dual role = shield + wall | Foster, Spears & Geruso (2018), Bharathi et al. (2020), Spate & Learmonth (1954), Ambedkar   | Amminabhavi (Dharwad) segregation; Dalits on periphery; open defecation vs Swachh Bharat; distorted sex ratio                                 | Spears-Geruso sanitation study; Karnataka > American South segregation; Amminabhavi village |

## MEMORY AIDS — Mnemonics

**Views on Villages (GAN):** Gandhi (glory) | Ambedkar (oppression) | Nehru (backwardness)

**Settlement Types (CSHD):** Clustered | Semi-clustered | Hamleted | Dispersed

**Settlement Factors (PCSE):** Physical | Cultural | Security | Economic

**Thorner's 3 Classes (MKM):** Malik | Kisan | Mazdoor

**Dhanangre's 5 Classes (LRMPL):** Landlords | Rich peasants | Middle peasants | Poor peasants | Landless

**Parsons' 5 Features (PAOFM):** Plurality | Aims | Order | Functional Unity | Maintenance

**3 Subsystems (CJP):** Caste-Jajmani | Joint Family | Panchayat

**Desai's 4 Trends (STAI):** Subsistence → surplus | Tech intro | Abolition of intermediaries | Institutions linked urban

**Globalization 8 Impacts (TDEJDJCA):** Trends(Desai) | Depeasantization | Employment-contract | Joint family disruption  
| Decline jajmani | J (new conflicts) | Cultural erosion | Agri mechanization

**Foster's Traditional Culture Features (SIA):** Stability | Identity | Adaptiveness

**5 Indian Barriers (CSCF<sup>2</sup>):** Caste | Sanitation | Caste-segregation(Karnataka) | Female infanticide | F (child marriage = Family honor)

**Lewis's 4 Ties (SERP):** Social(marriage) | Economic(trade) | Religious(pilgrimage) | Political

## INTER-TOPIC LINKAGES — Answer Building

| Link                                 | How to Use in Answer                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Jajmani ↔ Agrarian ↔ Globalization   | Jajmani sustained agrarian relations (Sec 4); globalization destroyed Jajmani (Sec 5) → changed agrarian class structure                                                      |
| Caste ↔ Settlement ↔ Segregation     | Caste shapes settlement (semi-clustered: center vs periphery in Sec 2) → same spatial hierarchy persists as "traditional culture barrier" (Karnataka, Sec 7)                  |
| Little Republic ↔ Social System      | Little Republic (Sec 3) assumes village = self-contained system; Parsons' social system (Sec 6) formalizes this; Lewis's cosmopolitanism shows the system is OPEN, not closed |
| Traditional Culture ↔ Globalization  | Foster's barriers (Sec 7) vs Globalization's disruption (Sec 5): traditional culture resists change; globalization forces it → tension = core of village transformation       |
| Village Studies ↔ All Topics         | Village studies (Sec 1) generated ALL the concepts discussed in Secs 2-7. Applied significance = these findings shaped policy (CDP, Tribal Sub-Plan, PRI)                     |
| Depeasantization ↔ Agrarian ↔ Status | Thorner's Kisan class declining (Sec 4) → Tilche's Patidars leaving farming (Sec 5) → farming no longer status marker → caste-class decoupling                                |